Different Meanings have been provided for the term "Secretary". They are as follows :

According to **The Oxford Dictionary,** a secretary is, "a person whose work is to write for others, especially one who is employed to conduct correspondence, keep records and to transact various other businesses for another person or for a society, corporation or public body".

According to **Webster's Dictionary** defines Secretary as, "one who is entrusted with private or secret matters and a confidential clerk, one who attends to correspondence, records of a private and confidential nature".

According to **Penguine Dictionary of Commerce** defines Secretary as, "the person who deals with the general administration of an organization, particularly with clerical work such as correspondence, taking minutes at meetings and keeping records".

According to **English Dictionary,** the word secretary has been defined as "a person who handles correspondence, keeps records,and does general clerical work for an individual, organization, etc.,"

10.3 Private Secretary

A private secretary is a person employed by a busy and an eminent person to assist him in all possible works including taking decisions from him. He has to represent his employer to do his private and confidential work. In many cases, the employer might not have good knowledge of English and has no idea about writing letters correctly. In such cases the private secretary must be a conscientious worker capable of understanding the full implications of any correspondence and sometimes he may have to alter, improve, rectify or completely rewrite the dictation given by his employer and place it before the employer for his signature.

Of course he will have to do it very tactfully so that his employer would not be offended owing to his lack of knowledge or education. In many occasions, he has to draft letters, reports or speeches himself on behalf of his employer. A private secretary must be a good short-hand typist but at the same time he must have other qualities.

10.4 Types of Secretary

1. Personal or private secretary
2. Secretary of a club
3. Secretary of a co-operative society



FIGURE 10.1 Secretary having informal chat with his Official Collegue Member



FIGURE 10.2 A Personal Secretary,while discharging her official duty at Office.

XII OSS_English version CHAPTER 10.indd 129 1/7/2020 6:12:03 PM